YISHUN INNOVA JUNIOR COLLEGE
JC 2 PRELIMINARY EXAMINATION
Higher 1

SUGGESTED ANSWER

Section A

Cluster 2 : Fieldwork

1 1 Urban reimaging has been widely adopted in many cities to revitalise declining urban areas and improve their liveability. In Manchester, the Sackville Street and Canal Street have undergone extensive regeneration, introducing new public spaces, mixed land uses and transport infrastructure. As Manchester's population continues to age, there is increasing emphasis on ensuring that regenerated urban environments are inclusive and meet the needs of elderly residents.

A group of 18 Geography students from Singapore's Champion Junior College visited Manchester from 1–5 December 2025 to investigate the inclusiveness of urban reimaging in meeting the needs of elderly residents in the Sackville Street and Canal Street.

The students developed the following research question:

How inclusive is urban reimaging in meeting the needs of elderly residents in Manchester's Sackville Street and Canal Street?

To investigate this question, the students conducted a questionnaire survey of 50 elderly residents and foreign visitors using convenience sampling. The respondents comprised :

60–69 years: 21 residents and 6 foreign visitors (27 respondents)
70–79 years: 13 residents and 3 foreign visitors (16 respondents)
80 years and above: 5 residents and 2 foreign visitors (7 respondents)

The survey examined respondents' perceptions of personal safety, accessibility, opportunities for social interaction and inclusion, and overall liveability. The students also carried out land-use mapping, pedestrian counts, and an accessibility audit to assess the provision of age-friendly infrastructure, including benches, ramps, lifts, tactile paving, pedestrian crossings and barrier-free access.

Resource 1 shows a map of the study area. Resource 2 shows photographs taken during the field investigation. Resource 3 provides the questionnaire used by the students. Resource 4 presents the data collected from the questionnaire survey.

(a) Explain whether the students' research question is suitable. [4]

Suggested answer :

- [**At suitable scale**] The students have devoted sufficient number of days to the investigations and also enough manpower to complete the primary investigation in the allocated time. (1)
- [**researchable or measurable**] The results for the research question can be addressed using primary study. The students have designed appropriate survey questionnaire to elicit the response for the hypothesis. The students also planned to carry out land-use mapping, pedestrian counts, and an accessibility audit to assess the provision of age-friendly infrastructure, including benches, ramps, lifts, tactile paving, pedestrian crossings and barrier-free access. The results are quantifiable. (1-2)
- [**Clearly defined**] e.g, The target group of "*elderly residents in Manchester's Sackville Street and Canal Street'* is clearly defined. (1)

Examiners' comments

You just have to remember the rules to responding to this question. PERIOD.

(b) Using Resource 2, explain which of the two study sites, Location A or B, is more suitable for investigating the impact of urban reimaging on elderly residents. [4]

Location A is more suitable.

- **High pedestrian activity** – The area has many people using the street, providing a good pool of potential respondents for a questionnaire.
- **Different types of people** – There appear to be people of different ages and backgrounds, allowing for a wider range of views to be collected. So it is more likely to find the respondent group, which is the elderly
- **Accessible and safe location** – The open pedestrianised street provides sufficient space for researchers to approach respondents without obstructing traffic.
- **Relevant to study** – The presence of seating, shops, cafés and public spaces means respondents can provide useful opinions about **how the area has been reimagined and its impact on users' quality of life** and also allow the
- **Comfortable-** provision of benches for the respondents to sit and answer the survey comfortably.

Location B is not more suitable, but if chosen can provide these reasons

- **Less pedestrian traffic** means it is more quiet, less likely to disturb the neighbourhood but it also means it is more dangerous.
  Accessible to public

Examiners' comments
Between the 2 locations, Location A is preferred as mentioned above. The clarity of the explanation will determine the response.

(c) Explain the strengths and limitations of the students' sampling strategy and sample size. [4]

Convenience sampling is
- q**uick and practical** – researchers can approach respondents in pedestrian areas, seating areas, cafés and public spaces. It is easier to obtain responses from **elderly participants who are comfortable answering the questionnaire**. It is appropriate for an exploratory investigation where the aim is to identify **general trends and perceptions**. (1)

But it does not stratified the respondents such that it is representative of the demographic in the areas. (1) Other issues include s**election bias** – people who are present at the site and willing to respond may not represent all elderly people. And l**ocation bias** – surveying only people in busy or accessible parts of the area may exclude less mobile elderly residents. (1)

Sample size of 50 provides quantitative data that can be presented using percentages, graphs and charts. There are respondents from three different elderly age groups, allowing some comparison between age groups. Having 39 residents provides a reasonably good basis for investigating the experiences of elderly residents. (1)

However, 50 is still relatively small compared with the much larger elderly population of the study area, so findings cannot be confidently generalised to all elderly residents. The sample is unevenly distributed: 27 respondents are aged 60–69, compared with only 7 aged 80+. Therefore, the views of the oldest group may be less reliable.The sample also contains 11 foreign visitors. (1)

Examiners' comments
Quite a few lost marks for not mentioning both sampling strategy and sample size, as required by the question.

(d) Using Resource 3, describe how you would improve the questionnaire. [4]

1. **Provide clear selection options for the respondent profile** – Include categories such as **age, gender, relationship to the area (resident/visitor), and frequency of visits**. This allows responses to be

compared between different groups and helps identify whether perceptions vary according to respondent characteristics. 2.

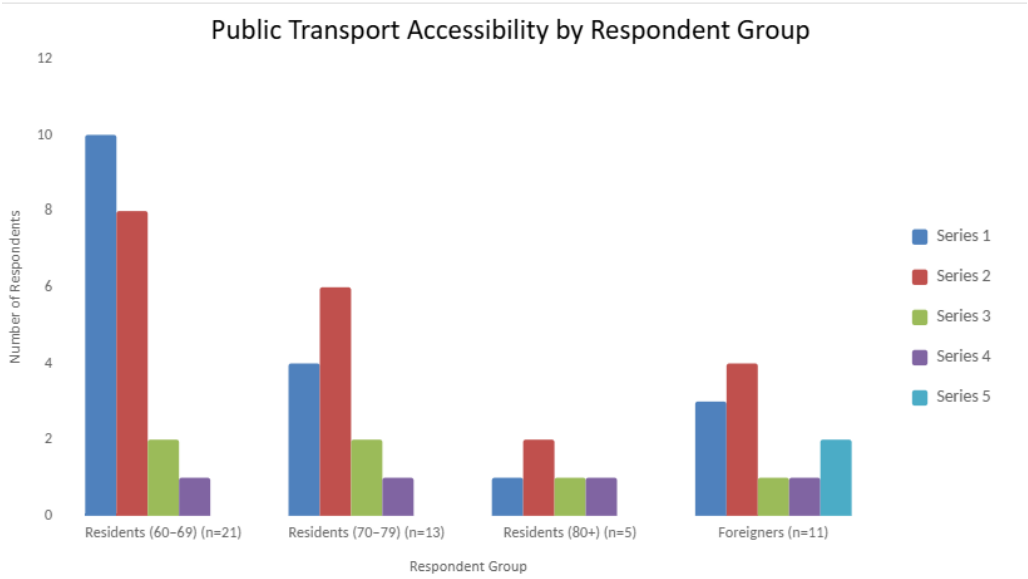
2. **Distinguish residents from visitors** – For instance question 9, clearly identify whether respondents are **residents or visitors** so that the responses of elderly residents can be analysed separately. This improves the **validity** of the findings because the research question specifically focuses on elderly residents.
3. **Include an open-ended question** – Add a question such as *"What is one improvement that would make this area more inclusive for elderly people?"* This allows respondents to **voice their opinions and suggest improvements** that may not be captured by the Likert-scale questions.
4. **The layout can be improved to help the respondents distinguish across different questions**. Because the elderly may find the words small and difficult to decipher.
5. **Consider carrying out the study in different time of the day.** Only state the date but no time of the day for the study**.**

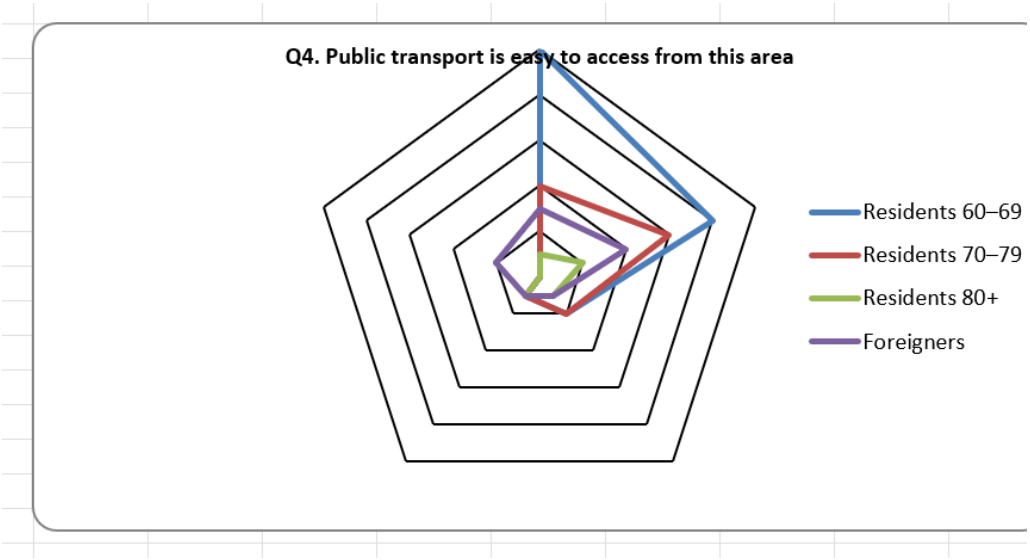
Examiners' comments

Respondent Profile

Question	Response
Age	□ 60–69 □ 70–79 □ 80+
Gender	□ Male □ Female □ Prefer not to say
Relationship to area	□ Resident □ Visitor
Frequency of visits	□ Daily □ Weekly □ Monthly □ Rarely

(e) With reference to Resource 4, explain the best way the students can present the data they collected from the questionaire. [4]





Category	Residents 60–69	Residents 70–79	Residents 80+	Foreigners
Strongly Agree	10	4	1	3
Agree	8	6	2	4
Neutral	2	2	1	1
Disagree	1	1	1	1
Strongly Disagree	0	0	0	2

(f) Evaluate the effectiveness of the data collection methods used to investigate whether urban reimaging has created an inclusive environment for elderly residents. [10]

The data collection methods used were **generally appropriate and reasonably effective** in investigating how inclusive urban reimaging has been for elderly residents in Sackville Street and Canal Street. The use of questionnaires, land-use mapping, pedestrian counts and an accessibility audit allowed the students to collect both **perception-based and observational data**, enabling triangulation. However, the effectiveness of the investigation was limited by sampling issues, the short duration of data collection and the difficulty of establishing whether urban reimaging itself caused improvements in inclusivity.

The **questionnaire survey of 50 respondents** was appropriate because inclusivity is partly based on the lived experiences and perceptions of elderly residents. Questions on safety, accessibility, social interaction and overall liveability allowed the students to directly assess whether the regenerated environment met elderly residents' needs. This is important because the physical presence of facilities does not necessarily mean that they are perceived as accessible or comfortable. However, the use of **convenience sampling** may have created sampling bias, as more mobile elderly people who were willing and able to participate may have been overrepresented. In addition, 11 of the 50 respondents were foreign visitors rather than residents, even though the research question specifically focuses on elderly residents. Visitors may have different experiences and expectations of the area. The sample was also uneven, with only seven respondents aged 80 and above. The students could improve the method by using **stratified or purposive sampling**, ensuring a larger and more representative sample of elderly residents across the different age groups and mobility levels.

The **accessibility audit and land-use mapping** were also appropriate because they provided more objective evidence of whether the physical environment was inclusive. The audit examined features such as benches, ramps, lifts, tactile paving and pedestrian crossings, while land-use mapping identified the availability and spatial distribution of facilities. These methods can complement questionnaire responses. For example, if elderly respondents reported that the area was difficult to navigate and the audit also identified limited barrier-free access, the findings would be strengthened through **triangulation**. However, the presence of facilities does not necessarily indicate that they are usable. A ramp may exist but be too steep, while a bench may be available but poorly located. Similarly, land-use mapping demonstrates the **availability** of facilities but not necessarily their **accessibility or affordability**. The audit could therefore be improved by assessing the quality, location, condition and usability of facilities rather than simply recording their presence or absence.

The **pedestrian counts** provided quantitative evidence of how the regenerated spaces were being used. Comparing pedestrian activity at different locations could identify areas that were more or less intensively used. This provides

useful evidence to complement the questionnaire and accessibility audit. However, pedestrian numbers measure **activity rather than inclusivity**. A high pedestrian count does not necessarily mean that elderly residents find the environment inclusive. Furthermore, the counts were conducted over a relatively short period from 1–5 December 2025, so results could have been influenced by the particular time of day, weekday or weekend, weather and seasonal conditions. Repeating counts at different times of day, on different days and under different weather conditions would improve reliability.

A major strength of the investigation is therefore **triangulation**. The questionnaire captures residents' perceptions, land-use mapping examines the availability of facilities, the accessibility audit assesses the physical environment, and pedestrian counts provide evidence of actual activity. If the different methods produce similar findings, confidence in the conclusion increases. Nevertheless, triangulation cannot completely overcome the limitations of the sampling strategy or the short duration of the investigation.

The most significant limitation is that the methods do not clearly establish **causality**. The students collected data on the current condition of Sackville Street and Canal Street, but this does not necessarily show that urban reimaging caused the environment to become more inclusive. For example, elderly residents may currently perceive the area positively because of factors unrelated to the regeneration. The investigation could be improved through a **before-and-after comparison**, using historical photographs, secondary data or interviews with long-term residents. Comparing the regenerated areas with a similar **non-regenerated area** would also help determine whether differences in inclusivity are actually associated with urban reimaging.

Overall, the methods were **appropriate because they examined both the physical environment and elderly residents' experiences, while triangulation strengthened the validity of the findings**. However, their effectiveness was only moderate in demonstrating whether urban reimaging itself had created greater inclusivity because of sampling bias, limited temporal coverage and the absence of before-and-after evidence. A larger, stratified resident sample, repeated observations, interviews and a comparison with a non-regenerated area would produce more valid, reliable and representative findings.

Appendix A

Levels	Marks	Generic Level Descriptors for H1 Fieldwork Evaluative Question
3	9–10	Evaluation is analytical and coherent. Response addresses the question and demonstrates good knowledge and understanding of fieldwork methods relevant to the given context.
2	5–8	Evaluation is mostly analytical and coherent. Weaker responses in this level will have evaluation that is broadly analytical and generally coherent. Response generally addresses the question and demonstrates adequate knowledge and understanding of fieldwork methods relevant to the given context.
1	1–4	Response is descriptive with limited or no analysis and evaluation. Response is fragmented and lacks clarity. Response lacks focus on the question and may be largely irrelevant to it. Response shows basic knowledge and understanding of fieldwork methods. Response has some, though limited, relevance to the given context.
0	0	No creditworthy response

Examiners' reports
Need to apply the J-A-I-L approach.

Section B

Cluster 1: Sustainable Future and Climate Change

2 Resource 5 shows Singapore's waste recycled (2015-2025). Resource 6 shows Singapore's changing plastic waste (2014-2023). Resource 7 shows garbage and sewage waste pile up on Mumbai's Juhu Beach. Resource 8 shows the changing Earth's surface temperature (1850 -2025).

(a) Using Resource 5, describe the changes in Singapore's waste recycling rates between 2015 and 2025. [4]

[General] Singapore's waste recycling rate showed a downward trend over the 11-year period..

[Specific] It remained relatively stable between 2015 and 2018, 60.6% in 2015, 61.0% in 2016, 61.3% in 2017, and peaked at 61.7% in 2018.

It then declined to 59.0% in 2019, before decreasing sharply to 51.7% in 2020, a fall of 7.3 percentage points in just one year.

It declined from 2019 to 2020, recovered moderately in 2021–2022, fell again in 2023–2024, before recovering slightly in 2025.

[Anomaly] The most notable anomaly occurred in 2020, when the recycling rate fell sharply from 59.0% to 51.7%, representing the largest year-on-year decline during the period.

(b) With reference to Resource 6, explain why plastic waste remains a significant waste management challenge in Singapore. [4]

[Economic] One reason is the rise in affluence and consumerism, which has increased the consumption of packaged goods and single-use plastics. Higher disposable incomes encourage greater spending on convenience products, resulting in more plastic waste being generated than can be effectively recycled.

[Context-specific] Secondly, as shown in Resource 6, the COVID-19 pandemic led to a surge in food delivery and online shopping, with services such as GrabFood and Foodpanda relying heavily on disposable plastic containers, cutlery and packaging. This caused plastic waste generation to increase while recycling activities were disrupted, contributing to the sharp fall in recycling rates in 2020.

[Technological] Another reason is that plastics are difficult and costly to recycle. Many plastic items are contaminated with food residue or consist of mixed materials, making them unsuitable for recycling. As a result, much of Singapore's plastic waste is incinerated instead of recycled.

[Economic] Businesses continue using plastic because it is cheap, lightweight and protects products.

[Political/Governance] Policies encourage reduction and recycling but rely heavily on voluntary behavioural change and take time to produce significant results, limiting their immediate effectiveness.

[Stakeholders' perspectives] Finally, stakeholder behaviour limits recycling efforts. While the government has introduced initiatives such as the Mandatory Packaging Reporting framework and beverage container return scheme, households often fail to separate recyclables properly, and businesses continue to rely on inexpensive plastic packaging because it is cost-effective and convenient.

(c) Using Resource 7, explain how the accumulation of plastic waste can reduce the liveability of nearby coastal communities. [4]

[Environmental] Firstly, the accumulation of plastic waste reduces environmental quality, as plastics pollute the coastline and marine environment. Wildlife such as fish, seabirds and turtles may ingest or become entangled in plastic debris, reducing biodiversity and degrading coastal ecosystems.

[Social] Secondly, plastic waste reduces the recreational and aesthetic value of the beach. Residents and tourists are less likely to visit polluted beaches for activities such as swimming, fishing or leisure, lowering their quality of life.

[Economic] Thirdly, the accumulation of plastic waste can negatively affect local livelihoods. Coastal communities that depend on tourism or fishing may experience reduced visitor numbers and lower fish catches due to polluted waters and damaged marine habitats, resulting in loss of income.

[Health] Finally, decomposing waste and stagnant water trapped among the plastics can create foul odours and provide breeding grounds for disease vectors, such as mosquitoes and rodents. This increases health risks and makes nearby neighbourhoods less pleasant to live in.

(d) Using Resources 7 and 8, explain how climate change may worsen the impacts of plastic pollution on aquatic ecosystems. [4]

Firstly, more frequent and intense storms and flooding associated with climate change can wash larger amounts of plastic waste from land into rivers and oceans. As shown in Resource 1, large accumulations of plastic already exist along coastlines. Increased surface runoff and stronger wave action can transport this waste further into marine ecosystems, exposing a greater number of marine organisms to plastic ingestion and entanglement.

Secondly, rising sea temperatures place marine organisms under physiological stress. Corals may bleach, while fish and other marine species experience reduced growth and reproductive success. Organisms already weakened by warming are less able to survive additional stress caused by ingesting plastics or becoming entangled in plastic debris, increasing mortality rates and reducing biodiversity.

Thirdly, climate change can accelerate the breakdown of plastics into microplastics through higher temperatures, stronger ultraviolet radiation and increased wave action. These microplastics are more easily ingested by plankton, shellfish and small fish, allowing plastics and associated toxic chemicals to move up the food chain through bioaccumulation and biomagnification.

Finally, rising sea levels and changing ocean currents can redistribute floating plastic waste to previously less affected coastal habitats such as mangroves, estuaries and coral reefs. This expands the geographical extent of plastic pollution, threatening important nursery grounds and reducing the resilience of aquatic ecosystems to climate change.

(e) Explain why no single waste management strategy can effectively address non hazardous solid waste problems [6]

No single waste management strategy can effectively address non-hazardous solid waste problems because different types of waste create different environmental, social and economic challenges that require multiple complementary approaches.

Firstly, recycling alone cannot solve the problem of increasing waste generation. Resource 1 shows that although Singapore recycled between 3.0 and 4.8 million tonnes of waste annually, the recycling rate declined from about 60.6% in 2015 to 52.1% in 2025, indicating that recycling has not kept pace with the amount of waste generated. This suggests that recycling is limited by contaminated or mixed waste streams and low public participation. Hence, waste reduction and reuse are also needed to reduce waste generation at source.

Secondly, changing consumer behaviour is equally important because waste generation continues to rise due to socio-economic factors. Resource 2 shows that plastic waste increased from about 850,000 tonnes in 2014 to over one million tonnes in 2022, while the value of Southeast Asia's food delivery market expanded rapidly from US$28 billion in 2018 to almost US$170 billion in 2023. During the COVID-19 pandemic, movement restrictions accelerated online food delivery, increasing the use of single-use plastic containers and packaging. Even after the pandemic, consumers continued to prefer the convenience of food delivery services. Therefore, recycling alone cannot offset rising plastic consumption, and measures such as reducing single-use plastics, producer responsibility and encouraging reusable packaging are also necessary.

Thirdly, disposal methods such as incineration and landfilling have their own limitations. Incineration can reduce waste volume and generate electricity, but it still emits greenhouse gases. Resource 4 shows that atmospheric carbon dioxide concentrations have increased from about 285 ppm in 1850 to over 420 ppm in 2023, alongside a rise in global temperatures of around 1.2°C, suggesting the need to minimise carbon emissions. Furthermore, incineration

produces ash that still requires disposal in landfills, while land availability is limited in many cities such as Singapore.

Finally, poor waste management continues to damage ecosystems and reduce liveability. Resource 3 shows a coastline covered almost entirely with plastic waste, illustrating how ineffective collection and disposal allow waste to accumulate in the environment. Such pollution degrades marine ecosystems, threatens wildlife through ingestion and entanglement, reduces the recreational and aesthetic value of beaches, and affects tourism and fisheries. These impacts cannot be prevented solely through end-of-pipe disposal methods but require upstream measures to reduce waste generation and improve collection systems.

Therefore, an integrated waste management approach is required. Governments need to introduce regulations and economic incentives (e.g. Extended Producer Responsibility and waste charging), businesses should redesign products and reduce unnecessary packaging, while households should practise the 3Rs (Reduce, Reuse and Recycle). Combining prevention, reuse, recycling, waste-to-energy technologies and safe disposal is more effective than relying on any single strategy because each addresses different stages of the waste management hierarchy.

3. Resource 9 shows the global climate risk index (2000-2019). Resource 10 shows some primary climate hazards. Resource 11 shows positive and negative climate feedback loop.

(a) Using Resource 9, describe the spatial pattern of areas vulnerable to climate change. [4]

[General] **Countries with the greatest vulnerability to climate change (ranked 1–20) are generally concentrated in tropical and subtropical regions**, particularly South and Southeast Asia, Central America and the Caribbean, and southeastern Africa. [1]

[Specific] **Countries with the greatest vulnerability are concentrated in South and Southeast Asia.** For example, Pakistan and Myanmar rank **1–10**, while India ranks **11–20**. [1]

[Specific] **Much of northern Africa has relatively low vulnerability.** For example, Algeria, Libya and Egypt rank **above 100**. [1]

[Specific] **Northern Europe generally has relatively low vulnerability compared with South and Southeast Asia.** For example, Norway, Sweden and Finland rank **above 100**. [1]

[Exception] **However, this relatively low vulnerability does not extend across all of Europe.** Germany is an exception, ranking **11–20**, indicating relatively high vulnerability [1] OR **Germany (ranked 11–20)** provides an exception because it lies in the temperate mid-latitudes.

Valid alternative points & evidence:

- Southeastern Africa has greater vulnerability than northern Africa. (Mozambique ranks **1–10** and Madagascar **11–20**, compared with Algeria and Libya at **above 100**.)
- Countries in western South America generally have greater vulnerability than those in the east. (Colombia, Peru and Bolivia rank **21–50**, compared with Brazil at **51–100**.)
- Mainland Southeast Asia shows contrasts in vulnerability. (Myanmar and Thailand rank **1–10**, while Malaysia ranks **above 100**.)

(b) With reference to Resources 9 and 10, explain why some urban areas are more vulnerable to climate change than others. [6]

Urban areas differ in their vulnerability to climate change because of differences in physical exposure, urban characteristics and adaptive capacity.

Firstly, **physical location** influences exposure to climate hazards. Low-lying coastal cities are more vulnerable to sea level rise, storm surges and coastal flooding than inland cities. For example, Singapore, Jakarta and Miami are highly exposed because much of their infrastructure is located close to sea level, whereas inland cities such as Johannesburg face little risk from sea level rise.

Secondly, **urban form and environmental characteristics** affect vulnerability. Highly built-up cities with extensive concrete and asphalt surfaces absorb and retain heat, intensifying the urban heat island (UHI) effect. Combined with more frequent heatwaves, cities such as Singapore and Tokyo experience higher temperatures that increase heat stress, energy demand and infrastructure deterioration. In contrast, cities with more green spaces and ventilation corridors experience lower heat accumulation.

Thirdly, **adaptive capacity** varies between cities. Wealthier cities generally have greater financial resources, technology and governance to invest in climate adaptation measures such as sea walls, flood barriers, drainage systems and heat-resilient infrastructure. For example, Singapore has invested heavily in coastal protection and drainage upgrades. In contrast, cities in many

lower-income countries often lack the financial and institutional capacity to implement such measures, making them more vulnerable to flooding, heatwaves and other climate-related hazards.

(c) Explain two positive impacts of contemporary climate change on places. [4]

For example:

Longer growing seasons in northern Europe and Canada.
Reduced winter heating costs.
Opening of Arctic shipping routes.
Expansion of tourism in previously colder regions.

(d) Explain why the study of ice cores provides convincing evidence of climate change. [4]

Ice cores provide convincing evidence of climate change because they preserve a continuous and long-term record of past climatic conditions over hundreds of thousands of years.

Firstly, annual layers of snow accumulate and compress into ice, allowing scientists to determine the age of each layer. This provides a chronological record of changes in climate over time.

Secondly, ice cores contain trapped air bubbles that preserve past atmospheric concentrations of greenhouse gases such as carbon dioxide (CO_2) and methane (CH_4). Scientists can directly measure these gases and compare them with present-day concentrations.

Thirdly, the oxygen isotope ratio ($^{18}O/^{16}O$) in the ice varies with temperature. Higher proportions of the heavier isotope indicate warmer climatic conditions, allowing scientists to reconstruct past temperatures.

Together, these records show that atmospheric greenhouse gas concentrations and global temperatures have increased rapidly since the Industrial Revolution. As the evidence is continuous, accurately dated and based on direct measurements of past atmospheric composition, ice cores provide convincing evidence of climate change.

(e) Using Resource 11, explain why there is uncertainty in projections of future climate change. [4]

Resource 11 shows that projections of future climate change are uncertain because the climate system contains both positive and negative feedback loops, which influence future warming in different ways.

Firstly, positive feedback loops amplify climate change. As shown in the resource, rising temperatures cause Arctic ice to melt, reducing the Earth's albedo. The darker ocean surface absorbs more solar radiation, leading to further warming and additional ice melt. The magnitude and rate of this amplification are difficult to predict accurately.

Secondly, negative feedback loops counteract warming. Higher temperatures increase evaporation, resulting in the formation of more low clouds that reflect incoming solar radiation back into space. This has a cooling effect that can partly offset warming. However, the extent to which cloud formation reduces future temperatures remains uncertain.

Therefore, because both positive and negative feedbacks operate simultaneously and interact in complex ways, it is difficult for climate models to accurately predict the overall rate and magnitude of future climate change.

Section C

Cluster 1 : Sustainable Future and Climate Change

Answer **two** questions.

Appendix B

Levels	Marks	Generic Level Descriptors for H1 Essays
4	11–13	Evaluation is analytical and coherent. Response is mostly well-supported by relevant material, including the appropriate use of examples. Response features accurate geographical knowledge and reflects adequate understanding of the subject content relevant to the question.
3	8–10	Evaluation is broadly analytical and generally coherent. Response is moderately well-supported by relevant material, including some appropriate use of examples. Response features accurate geographical knowledge and reflects adequate understanding of the subject content relevant to the question.
2	5–7	Response is largely descriptive with limited analysis and evaluation. Response is partly coherent and may lack clarity in parts. Response is poorly supported by relevant materials, including the limited use of examples. Response features inaccurate geographical knowledge and poor understanding of the subject content relevant to the question.
1	1–4	Response is descriptive with no analysis or evaluation. Response is fragmented and lacks clarity. Response consists of unsupported assertions. Response features largely inaccurate geographical knowledge and a lack of understanding of the subject content relevant to the question.
0	0	No creditworthy response

4. 'Housing policies are the most important factor in creating liveable cities.' Evaluate this statement. [13]

Housing policies are a fundamental foundation of liveability, particularly because they directly influence **comfort, security, availability and affordability**. However, they cannot be considered universally the most important factor. Their effectiveness depends on whether housing is **accessible to employment and services** (including sanitation, and proximity to amenities) and whether other dimensions of liveability, such as transport, environmental quality and social inclusion, are adequately addressed.

Furthermore, what constitutes a liveable city differs between cities, population groups and individuals. Hence, housing policies are most important where housing insecurity or affordability is the dominant constraint, but in cities where housing needs are already adequately met, other factors may have greater marginal importance. Ultimately, liveability is best achieved through a combination of effective top-down policies and bottom-up participation that responds to the needs of different groups.

5. Evaluate the success of the strategies to address the issues faced by women living in cities. [13]

Strategies to address the issues faced by women in cities have been partially successful, but their effectiveness varies considerably according to the socioeconomic and cultural context of cities. In high-income cities, strategies have contributed to increased female employment and a narrowing of gender income

inequalities, but political underrepresentation, the glass ceiling and unequal domestic responsibilities continue to constrain women's quality of life. In lower-income cities, strategies such as improving women's access to education and strengthening safety can generate substantial improvements, but their success is often constrained by patriarchal norms, limited economic opportunities and inadequate enforcement. Hence, no single strategy can be regarded as universally successful. The most effective approach is likely to combine top-down measures such as legislation, infrastructure and education with bottom-up approaches that empower women and challenge social norms. Ultimately, strategies are most successful when they address not only women's access to opportunities but also the structural and cultural barriers that prevent women from benefiting fully from them.

6. 'International cooperation is the key to addressing future climate change.' Evaluate the validity this statement. [13]

International cooperation is validly described as the key to addressing future climate change because the scale and transboundary nature of climate change make unilateral action insufficient. It is particularly important for coordinating mitigation, mobilising climate finance and facilitating technology transfer. However, international cooperation alone cannot guarantee successful outcomes. States must implement commitments, TNCs must change investment and production practices, while NGOs and communities provide bottom-up pressure, accountability and local knowledge. The relative importance of each actor also varies between mitigation and adaptation and according to the capacity and vulnerability of different places. Therefore, international cooperation is best understood as an essential enabling framework rather than a standalone solution. The most effective response to future climate change is likely to be a multi-scalar, multi-stakeholder partnership in which international cooperation enables, rather than replaces, action by states, TNCs, NGOs and local communities.

[TOTAL MARKS : 100]

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